Customer Service Agreement

Meridian Freight Co. · Standard Terms and Conditions · Version 2026-1 · Effective February 1, 2026

1. Parties and scope

This Customer Service Agreement (the "Agreement") is between Meridian Freight Co., an Ohio corporation with its head office at 2400 Harbor Logistics Drive, Columbus, Ohio ("Meridian"), and the business customer named in the signed order form (the "Customer").

The Agreement governs all transportation, warehousing and related services Meridian provides to the Customer. If the order form and these terms conflict, the order form prevails. Terms printed on the Customer's purchase orders or shipping documents do not apply, even if Meridian signs or accepts them.

2. Services

Meridian offers the following services:

- **Full truckload (FTL):** a dedicated trailer for one Customer's goods, from pickup to delivery.
- **Less than truckload (LTL):** shipments of 1 to 6 pallets combined with other customers' goods.
- **Warehousing:** storage, picking, packing and cross-docking in Meridian's warehouses in Columbus, Louisville and Indianapolis.
- **Last-mile delivery:** delivery to business addresses within 150 miles of a Meridian warehouse.

Meridian does not deliver to private residences, and does not transport live animals, cash, precious metals, firearms or perishable goods requiring refrigeration.

3. Quotes, orders and pickups

3.1 Quotes

Quotes are valid for 14 calendar days from the date they are issued. Prices include all standard handling but exclude the fuel surcharge, accessorial charges and taxes. The fuel surcharge is adjusted every Monday based on the U.S. national average diesel price published by the Energy Information Administration.

3.2 Booking a pickup

Pickups must be booked through the customer portal at least 24 hours in advance. Same-day pickups are available when booked before 11:00 AM local time, subject to capacity, for a fee of $95 per pickup. Standard pickup hours are 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday to Friday.

3.3 Shipment preparation

The Customer must package goods to withstand normal transportation, palletize them where required, and label each package with the delivery address and the Meridian shipment number. Pallets must not exceed 2,200 pounds or 72 inches in height. Meridian may refuse or re-package shipments that are not properly prepared, at the Customer's expense.

4. Delivery

4.1 Delivery times

Estimated transit times are shown in the customer portal. Meridian aims to deliver every shipment on the estimated date but does not guarantee delivery dates unless the Customer buys the Guaranteed Delivery option, which costs 18% of the freight charge. If a guaranteed shipment is delivered late for reasons within Meridian's control, the Guaranteed Delivery fee and the freight charge for that shipment are refunded in full.

4.2 Loading, unloading and detention

Each pickup and delivery includes 2 hours of free time for loading or unloading. After that, detention is charged at $75 per hour, billed in 15-minute increments. If a delivery cannot be completed because the receiver is closed or refuses the goods, Meridian returns the shipment to the nearest warehouse and charges a redelivery fee of $150, plus storage.

5. Charges and payment

5.1 Invoices and payment terms

Meridian invoices weekly. Invoices are payable within 30 days of the invoice date (net 30). Overdue amounts bear interest at 1.5% per month, or the maximum rate allowed by law if lower. Meridian may suspend services if any invoice is more than 45 days overdue, after giving the Customer 5 business days of written notice.

5.2 Disputed invoices

The Customer must notify Meridian in writing of any disputed invoice within 15 days of the invoice date, explaining the reason. The Customer must pay the undisputed part of the invoice on time. Invoices not disputed within 15 days are considered accepted.

5.3 Accessorial charges

Service	Charge
Same-day pickup	$95 per pickup
Detention after 2 free hours	$75 per hour
Liftgate service	$65 per stop
Inside delivery	$85 per stop
Redelivery	$150 per attempt
Hazardous materials handling	$120 per shipment
Address correction	$25 per shipment

6. Warehousing

Storage is billed per pallet position per month at $18, with a minimum charge of $250 per month. Cross-docked goods may be stored free of charge for up to 7 calendar days after arrival; from the eighth day, the standard storage rate applies. Inbound receiving is charged at $6 per pallet and outbound handling at $6 per pallet.

Meridian performs a full inventory count once a year at no charge. Additional counts requested by the Customer are billed at $55 per hour. Inventory differences of less than 0.5% of the units received in a year are considered normal and are not compensated.

7. Hazardous materials

Meridian accepts hazardous materials of the following U.S. Department of Transportation classes only: Class 3 (flammable liquids), Class 8 (corrosive materials) and Class 9 (miscellaneous dangerous

goods). The Customer must give written notice at least 48 hours before the pickup and provide the safety data sheet and correct shipping papers.

Meridian does not accept explosives (Class 1), gases (Class 2), radioactive materials (Class 7) or any material that requires a hazardous materials security plan. The Customer is responsible for all costs, fines and damages caused by hazardous materials that were declared incorrectly or not declared.

8. Liability for loss and damage

8.1 Limit of liability

Meridian is liable for physical loss of or damage to goods while they are in its care, unless the loss was caused by the Customer, by the nature of the goods, or by a force majeure event. Meridian's liability is limited to the lower of the actual value of the goods or $2.50 per pound of the lost or damaged goods, with a maximum of $100,000 per shipment. Meridian is not liable for lost profits, delay or other indirect losses.

8.2 Declared value coverage

The Customer may increase Meridian's liability by declaring a higher value for a shipment at booking. Declared value coverage costs 0.8% of the declared value, with a minimum of $40 per shipment, and covers the declared value up to $500,000 per shipment.

8.3 Making a claim

1. Visible damage or shortage must be noted on the delivery receipt when the shipment is delivered.
2. Concealed damage, meaning damage discovered after delivery when the packaging is opened, must be reported to Meridian in writing within 5 days of delivery. Keep the goods and packaging for inspection.
3. Formal claims must be filed in the customer portal within 9 months of the delivery date, or, for lost shipments, of the expected delivery date. Include the invoice for the goods and photos of the damage.
4. Meridian acknowledges claims within 30 days and pays approved claims within 30 days of approval.

Freight charges must be paid even when a claim is open; claim amounts may not be deducted from invoices.

9. Service levels

Meridian targets an on-time delivery rate of 97%, measured each calendar quarter across all of the Customer's shipments, excluding delays caused by the Customer, the receiver or force majeure. If the on-time rate falls below 95% in a quarter, the Customer receives a credit of 5% of that quarter's freight charges, applied to the next invoice. The Customer can follow the on-time rate in the monthly report available in the customer portal.

10. Insurance and force majeure

Meridian maintains cargo insurance of at least $1,000,000 per occurrence and general liability insurance of at least $2,000,000 per occurrence, and provides certificates of insurance on request.

Neither party is responsible for delays or failures caused by events beyond its reasonable control, such as severe weather, natural disasters, war, strikes outside the party's own workforce, government actions or widespread infrastructure failures. If such an event lasts more than 30 days, either party may terminate the affected services with written notice.

11. Confidentiality and data

Each party keeps the other party's non-public business information confidential and uses it only to perform this Agreement. This obligation lasts during the Agreement and for 3 years after it ends. Shipment data is processed according to Meridian's privacy notice; Meridian does not sell Customer data.

12. Term and termination

This Agreement starts on the date the order form is signed and lasts for one year. It renews automatically for successive one-year periods unless either party gives at least 60 days of written notice before the end of the current period. Either party may terminate the Agreement if the other party materially breaches it and does not fix the breach within 30 days of receiving written notice.

On termination, the Customer must pay all outstanding invoices and collect any goods stored in Meridian's warehouses within 30 days. Goods not collected may be returned to the Customer at its expense.

13. Governing law and disputes

This Agreement is governed by the laws of the State of Ohio. The parties will first try to resolve any dispute through good-faith negotiation between senior managers, then through mediation. If the dispute is not resolved within 60 days, it may be brought before the state or federal courts in Franklin County, Ohio.

Notices under this Agreement must be in writing and sent by email to the contacts named in the order form, with a copy to legal@meridianfreight.example for notices to Meridian.